

Code of Conduct – Ethics & Compliance
Effective Date: January 1, 2025
Owner: Legal & Compliance Department

1. Respectful Workplace

1.1 All employees, contractors, and vendors must treat each other with dignity and respect. Harassment, discrimination, bullying, or retaliation of any kind is strictly prohibited.

1.2 Harassment includes: unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, offensive jokes or comments about race, religion, gender identity, sexual orientation, age, disability, or any protected characteristic, and any physical or verbal conduct that creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive work environment.

1.3 Discrimination in hiring, promotion, assignment, or termination based on protected characteristics is prohibited under Company policy and local laws. Any employee who believes they have experienced discrimination should report it immediately as described in Section 4.

2. Reporting Violations

2.1 Employees are strongly encouraged to report any known or suspected violation of this Code of Conduct. Reporting can be done through any of the following channels:

a) Email directly to ethics@company.com (emails are reviewed by the Compliance Officer, not the employee's manager).

b) Anonymous hotline: 1-800-555-0199 (operated by an independent third party, no call recording).

c) Reporting to the employee's HR Business Partner or any member of the Legal team.

2.2 Retaliation against any person who reports a violation in good faith is a separate and serious violation of this Code, subject to immediate termination. Good faith means the person believed the information was true when reported, even if an investigation later determines no violation occurred.

2.3 Reports may be anonymous, but anonymous reports are more difficult to investigate. The Company will nevertheless make reasonable efforts to investigate all credible reports.

3. Gifts, Entertainment, and Conflicts of Interest

3.1 Employees may accept occasional, modest gifts from vendors or clients, provided the gift is:

- a) Non-cash (e.g., branded merchandise, flowers, food items) with a value below \$50,
- b) Not given in exchange for a business decision or preferential treatment, and
- c) Disclosed to the employee's manager.

3.2 Cash gifts, gift cards, loans, or any item valued over \$50 must be declined. If declining would cause offense, the employee must accept and then immediately report to the Compliance Officer, who will either return the item or donate it to charity.

3.3 Conflicts of interest must be disclosed in writing to the Legal Department. A conflict of interest exists when an employee's personal interests (e.g., financial stake, family relationship) could interfere with their duty to act in the best interests of the Company. Examples include:

- Having a relative employed by a competitor or vendor,
- Owning more than 5% of a publicly traded vendor,
- Serving on the board of a non-profit that does business with the Company.

3.4 Failure to disclose a known conflict of interest is a violation of this Code and may result in disciplinary action.

4. Use of Company Resources and Information

4.1 Company resources – including computers, email, internet access, printers, and office supplies – must be used primarily for business purposes. Incidental personal use is permitted as long as it does not interfere with work, violate other policies, or consume excessive resources.

4.2 Employees may not use Company confidential information for personal gain. Confidential information includes: customer lists, pricing strategies, unreleased product features, financial results prior to public release, and any document marked “Confidential” or “Internal Only”.

4.3 Insider trading is strictly prohibited. No employee may buy or sell securities of a publicly traded company based on material, non-public information obtained through their work.

5. External Communications and Social Media

5.1 Employees speaking publicly on behalf of the Company – including at conferences, in press interviews, or in official blog posts – must have prior approval from the Communications Department.

5.2 On personal social media accounts, employees must not:

- a) Disclose confidential information,
- b) Impersonate the Company or imply they are speaking officially unless explicitly authorized,
- c) Attack competitors, customers, or colleagues in a manner that could harm the Company’s reputation.

5.3 The Company respects employees’ rights to discuss wages, working conditions, and collective action under applicable labor laws. Nothing in this policy prohibits protected concerted activity.

6. Consequences of Violations

6.1 The Company will investigate all reported violations promptly and impartially. Investigations may involve interviews, document reviews, and forensic analysis of digital systems.

6.2 Depending on the severity and circumstances, consequences may include:

- Mandatory training or counseling,
- Written warning placed in the employee’s personnel file,
- Suspension without pay,
- Termination of employment,
- Referral to law enforcement for criminal conduct.

6.3 All consequences are determined by the Compliance Officer in consultation with HR and Legal, and are final.